

NICK VAN DEN DUNGEN

Full-stack engineer · open to CTO, founding-engineer & full-stack roles

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SUMMARY

I build products end to end, from the first idea to the people using them. At Soil Scout I grew from Full Stack Engineer into **Lead Full Stack Engineer**, leading development of The Hub and the infrastructure behind **6.5M+ sensor uploads an hour**. Since June 2026 I have been founding **Tiny Tarrasque**, an offline-first tabletop RPG app that I build solo with AI agents. I learned to code through C and C++ at Hive Helsinki, and years of teaching and coaching taught me to explain things clearly.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Engineer

Tiny Tarrasque

📅 Jun 2026 – now

📍 Helsinki, Finland

- Building an offline-first character sheet app for in-person tabletop RPG groups with **React Native**, **Expo**, **TypeScript** and **Zustand**. Friends alpha October 2026, public beta planned for December 2026. [Case study ↗](#)
- Designed a rules engine that knows no game: it evaluates a character as a dependency graph, and the game rules ship as validated JSON data packs. Old saves always load through versioned migrations.
- Ship solo with an AI-agent workflow (**Claude Code**, **Codex**): written guardrails for the agents, one pull request per task, CI on every PR, and a typecheck and test gate (85 test files) before anything is done.
- Run it as a product: every milestone ends with a usability test with a real player, and scope is cut rather than letting dates slip.

Full Stack Engineer → Lead Full Stack Engineer

Soil Scout

📅 Oct 2024 – Jun 2026

📍 Helsinki, Finland

- Full Stack Engineer from October 2024; promoted to **Lead Full Stack Engineer** in October 2025.
- **Technical ownership**: led development of The Hub, the web dashboard for Soil Scout's buried soil sensors. Owned delivery and technical choices, bridging in-house developers and external consultants.
- **Full-stack development**: designed, built and deployed features in **Python (Django)**, **React** and **Tailwind CSS** to visualise real-time IoT telemetry.
- **Data infrastructure**: optimised **PostgreSQL** and **TimescaleDB** pipelines on **GCP** to reliably ingest **6.5M+ sensor uploads an hour**, and tracked down production bugs.
- **DevOps**: automated CI/CD and infrastructure provisioning with **GitHub Actions** and **Ansible**.
- **Hiring**: built the technical recruitment pipeline from scratch, with practical coding assignments and interviews focused on how candidates think and collaborate.

OTHER PROJECTS

- **This portfolio**: static-exported site in **Next.js**, **TypeScript** and **Tailwind CSS**, built with an AI-agent review loop. [nickvandendungen.com ↗](#)
- **Procedural character API**: a type-safe REST API in **Kotlin** that procedurally generates tabletop RPG characters, with the data layer kept separate from the business logic. [GitHub ↗](#)

SKILLS

Product	TypeScript, React, React Native, Expo, Next.js, Svelte, Tailwind CSS, Zustand
Backend & data	Python, Django, Django REST, Node.js, REST API design, WebSockets / socket.io, PostgreSQL, TimescaleDB, Supabase, Kotlin
Infra & quality	GCP, Docker, Terraform, Linux, GitHub Actions, Ansible, Jest, Cypress, Playwright
Working with AI	Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, MCP servers, agentic workflows, LLM evals, local LLMs
Foundations	C, C++, Unix / POSIX, memory management
Languages	Dutch (native), English (fluent), Finnish (A2)

EDUCATION

Software Engineering (student & peer mentor)

Hive Helsinki

📅 2022 – 2024

📍 Helsinki, Finland

- Project-based, peer-to-peer curriculum in systems programming (**C**, **C++**): memory management, Unix internals and debugging, built from the ground up. Peer-reviewed 200+ code submissions.
- Board member and head of internal relations of the student association (Hexagon ry), 2023–2024: organised community events for students. I still give the occasional workshop there.
- **Transcendence (final project)**: led the front end and helped across the rest of the stack of a team-built website for real-time 3D Pong (**Three.js**) with accounts, match history and tournaments, on **Django REST** and **PostgreSQL** services, fully dockerised. [GitHub](#) ↗
- **MiniShell**: a Bash-like shell in C with processes, pipes, redirections and signal handling. [GitHub](#) ↗

Full Stack Open

University of Helsinki

📅 2023 – 2024

📍 Helsinki, Finland

- Built and deployed full-stack JavaScript apps (MongoDB, Express, React, Node.js) with automated pipelines and unit and end-to-end tests (**Jest**, **Cypress**). Wrote a medical front end, Patientor, in strict **TypeScript**.

Bachelor of Sport Science

HAN University of Applied Sciences

📅 2012 – 2016

📍 Nijmegen, Netherlands

- Sport and leisure management: team dynamics, project coordination and leading groups.

BEFORE SOFTWARE

- **Dutch language & culture teacher** (part-time), NTC Finland, 2021–2024: taught young learners.
- **After-school instructor** (part-time), Peuhis ry, 2020–2022.
- **Wilderness guide & snowmobile instructor**, Ruka Safaris, Finland, 2018–2019.
- **Activity instructor**, Explore the North, Sweden, 2017–2018: snowmobile tours and northern-light expeditions.
- **Snowboard instructor** (freelance), Rukakeskus / Pyhäntunturi, Finland, 2016–2017.
- **Bootcamp instructor**, City Bootcamp NL, 2013–2015 (during my degree): led group sessions and trained other instructors.